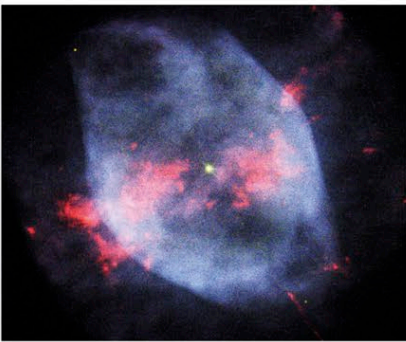
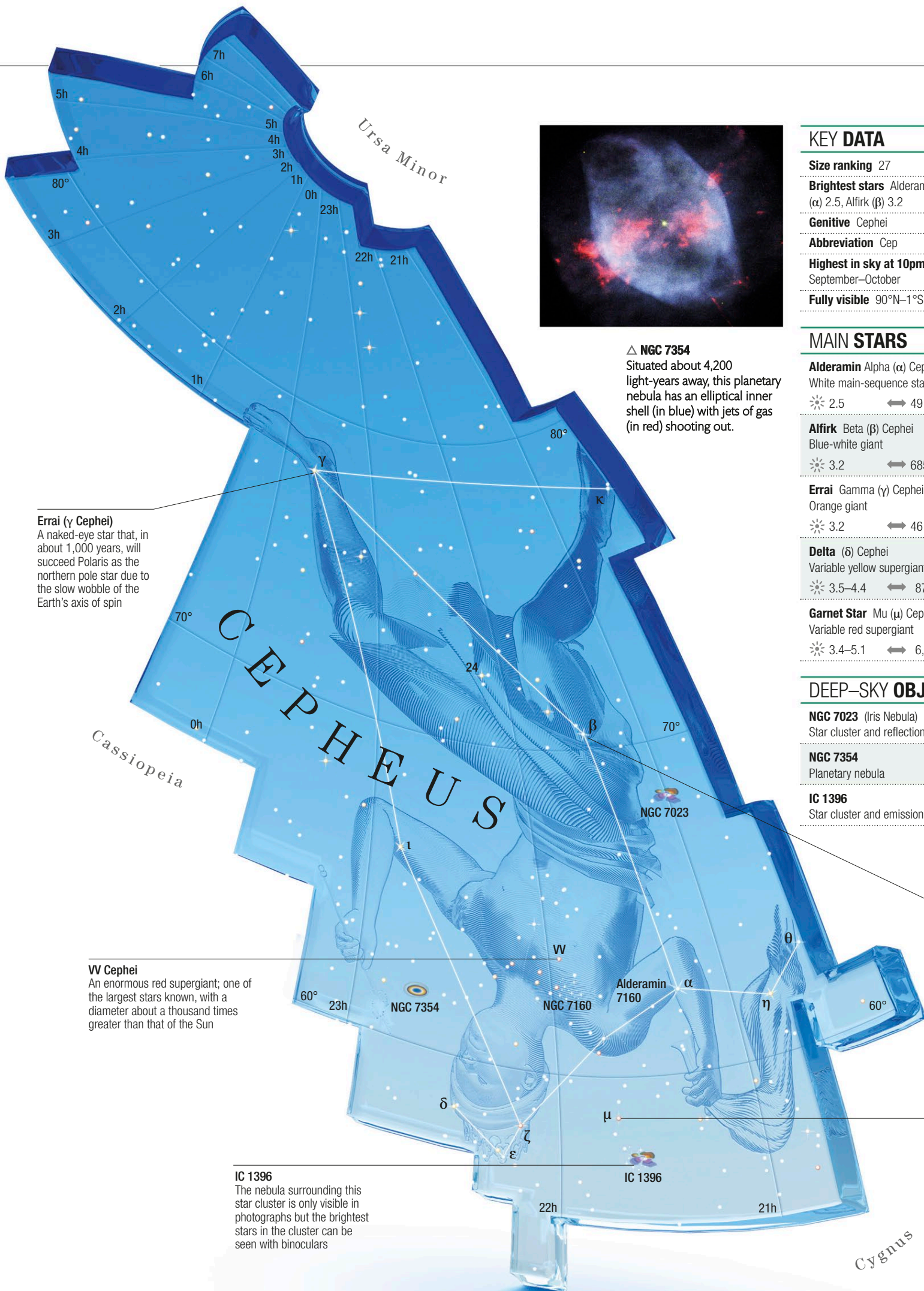




△ NGC 7354
Situating about 4,200 light-years away, this planetary nebula has an elliptical inner shell (in blue) with jets of gas (in red) shooting out.

Errai (γ Cephei)
A naked-eye star that, in about 1,000 years, will succeed Polaris as the northern pole star due to the slow wobble of the Earth's axis of spin

VV Cephei
An enormous red supergiant; one of the largest stars known, with a diameter about a thousand times greater than that of the Sun

IC 1396
The nebula surrounding this star cluster is only visible in photographs but the brightest stars in the cluster can be seen with binoculars

Alfirk (β Cephei)
A naked-eye star with a fainter companion visible through binoculars or a small telescope

Garnet Star (μ Cephei)
A large, luminous supergiant with a noticeably red colour, from which comes its popular name, given by English astronomer William Herschel

KEY DATA

Size ranking 27
Brightest stars Alderamin (α) 2.5, Alfirk (β) 3.2
Genitive Cephei
Abbreviation Cep
Highest in sky at 10pm September–October
Fully visible 90°N–1°S



CHART 1

MAIN STARS

Alderamin Alpha (α) Cephei
White main-sequence star
☼ 2.5 ↔ 49 light-years

Alfirk Beta (β) Cephei
Blue-white giant
☼ 3.2 ↔ 685 light-years

Errai Gamma (γ) Cephei
Orange giant
☼ 3.2 ↔ 46 light-years

Delta (δ) Cephei
Variable yellow supergiant
☼ 3.5–4.4 ↔ 870 light-years

Garnet Star Mu (μ) Cephei
Variable red supergiant
☼ 3.4–5.1 ↔ 6,000 light-years

DEEP-SKY OBJECTS

NGC 7023 (Iris Nebula)
Star cluster and reflection nebula

NGC 7354
Planetary nebula

IC 1396
Star cluster and emission nebula